DIRECTORATE OF RESEARCH

SRM Institute of Science and Technology

Ramapuram & Trichy Campus

PH.D. ADMISSIONS — WRITTEN TEST & INTERVIEW

Centralized Procedure & Guidelines

To:

- The Chairman
- Chief Director
- Director Admissions
- Deans/Heads of Institutions (HoI)
- Institute Research Coordinators
- Ph.D. Admission Coordinators (DoR)
- Department Research Coordination Committees (DRCC)

This document outlines the standardized procedures for the written test and interview process pertaining to Ph.D. admissions, implemented under the centralized framework established by the Directorate of Research (DoR) as per the chairman's direction. All the HOIs are requested to adhere strictly to the guidelines set forth herein to ensure transparency, uniformity, and efficient execution of the admission process.

1. Written Test Details

The written examination will be conducted in offline mode as per the following specifications:

Mode	Offline (Pen and Paper)
Date	As per notification
Timing	10:00 AM – 12:00 Noon
Duration	2 Hours
Venue	To be decided by the respective Head of Institution (HoI)
Maximum Marks	50 marks (scaled to 70 marks as per SRM KTR norms)

Exemption Clause: Candidates who have qualified in UGC-NET, CSIR-NET, GATE, or any equivalent national-level examination are exempted (within the validity) from the written test, as per university guidelines.

2. Examination Materials & Distribution

The DRCC shall submit two sets of question papers for each session, and the DoR will finalize the question paper by either selecting one set, combining questions from both sets, or shuffling questions between campuses. Department-wise, a common question paper shall be prepared and administered for both campuses. All printed examination materials will be handed over by the Directorate of Research (DoR) to the respective Head of the Institution (HoI) at 09:00 AM on the day of the examination. The DoR will provide the following documents on the day of the examination:

1. Question Paper
2. OMR Answer Sheet
3. Attendance Sheet
4. Question and Answer Sheet Collection Form
5. Interview Evaluation Sheet
6. Supervisor Preference Form (To be filled by the candidate at the time of interview)
7. Certificate Verification Form

3. Examination Procedure

3.1 Conduct of Examination

- The examination will be conducted strictly between 10:00 AM and 12:00 Noon.
- Attendance must be recorded using the prescribed attendance sheet.
- Absentee candidates must be noted clearly in the prescribed format.

3.2 Post-Examination Collection

- Upon conclusion of the examination, all OMR answer sheets and question papers must be collected from candidates.
- The collected materials must be handed over immediately to the designated research coordinators.
- Research Coordinators are responsible for submitting all materials to the DoR for evaluation without delay.

4. Evaluation Procedure

The written examination answer sheets will undergo a two-stage evaluation process:

Stage	Evaluator
First Evaluation	DRCC / Head of Department (HoD) or designated faculty at the DoR
Second Evaluation	Members of the Directorate of Research

Marks will be recorded in the prescribed format. The written examination carries 50 marks, which will be scaled to 70 marks in accordance with SRM KTR norms.

4.1 Document Verification

Before the commencement of written test DRCC members must verify the original documents of all eligible candidates using the Certificate Verification Form provided.

5. Interview Process

Commencement Time	1.00 PM onwards
Panel Composition	Committee proposed by HoI + one external member nominated by the DoR
Shortlisting	No shortlisting based on written test scores; all eligible candidates must attend the interview.
Total Marks	30 Marks

5.1 Evaluation Criteria

Each interview panel member must independently evaluate each candidate and enter the marks in the given evaluation sheet. After the interview is completed, the signed copies of the evaluation sheets must be submitted to the DoR without delay. The final interview score will be the average of all individual panel member evaluations.

Evaluation Parameter	Marks Allocated
Subject Knowledge	10
Future Research Plan / Proposal	10
Presentation Skills	5
Research Experience	5
Total	**30**

6. Supervisor Selection & Rank List

6.1 Final Scoring Weightage

Component	Weightage
Written Test (scaled to 70 marks)	70%
Interview (30 marks)	30%
Minimum Combined Score for Provisional Selection	**55% ***

*A relaxation of 5% marks will be granted in the entrance examination for candidates belonging to SC/ST/OBC/differently-abled categories, the Economically Weaker Section (EWS), and other categories, as per the norms of the Commission from time to time.
*To be considered for selection, candidates must secure a minimum of 50% marks separately in both the written examination and the interview.
*The Doctoral Research Coordination Committee (DRCC) reserves the right to increase the minimum cutoff marks based on factors such as the number of vacancies and the level of competition. However, the cutoff shall not be less than 55%.

6.2 Rank List Preparation & Supervisor Assignment

- The DoR will prepare the final rank list based on the combined scores from the written test and interview.
- The rank list will be submitted to the respective HoI, along with the selection committee, which will assign supervisors based on merit order and considering the preference given by the candidates.
- Supervisor assignment will strictly follow the merit list ranking.
- Consent forms will be obtained from both the assigned supervisor and the selected scholar by DoR.

7. Approval Workflow & Result Announcement

The selection process follows a structured multi-level approval workflow before results are announced:

- Each department (through the DRCC) submits the Minutes of the Meeting in the prescribed format to DoR.
- After the verification of the director research, the final selection list, along with supervisor assignments, is submitted to the Chairman for review and approval.
- Upon Chairman approval, the DoR will forward the list to the Vice Chancellor, SRM Kattankulathur for final approval.

- Following VC approval, the results, along with the allocated supervisor details, will be officially communicated to selected candidates via email.

This centralized approach has been designed to ensure transparency, uniformity, and efficient execution of the Ph.D. admission process across all departments and campuses. All Deans, HoIs, and DRCC members are requested to comply with the above procedures and coordinate accordingly.

Issued by:

Director of Research (DoR)
SRM Institute of Science and Technology
Ramapuram & Trichy Campus